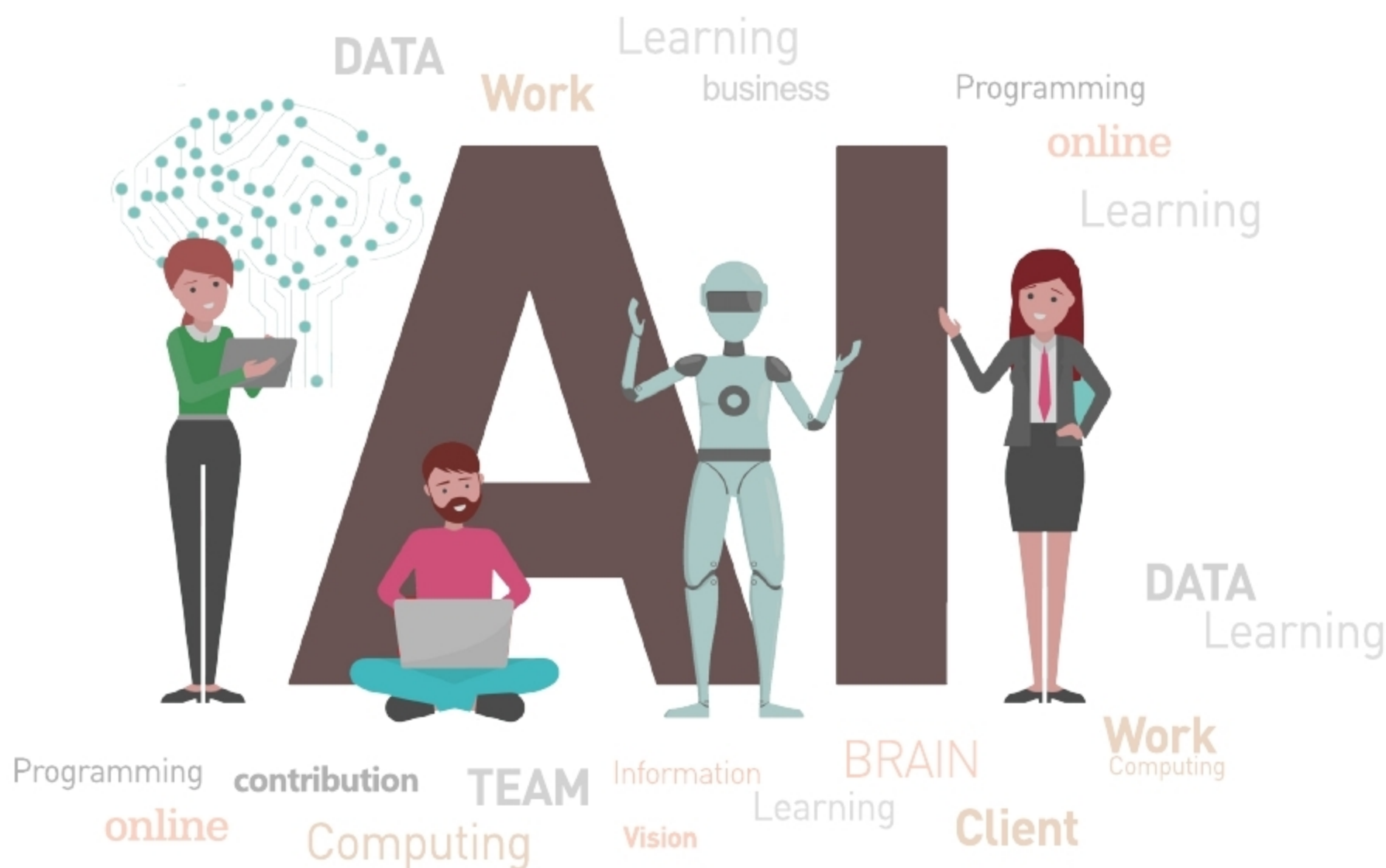


Potential Risks of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial intelligence (AI) is benefiting society in about every way possible. AI-driven devices are becoming cognitive enough to aid people in times of need. However, AI can be a great risk to society if it ends up in the wrong hands.



Last year, Alexa alerted the police in New Mexico after it heard its owner threaten his girlfriend, creating a havoc for the couple who were simply having a heated discussion. AI systems can self-learn. But will these be able to take the right decisions based on their social impact? For example, if you command your driverless car to take you to your destination at the earliest, how will the machine analyse it? Will it exceed the speed limit, and harm people in its way?

Researchers all over the world are working collaboratively to frame policies and safety rules to check verification, validity, security and control of AI.

Recursive self-improvement in AI systems could potentially trigger an intelligence that could leave human intellect behind. Creation of strong AI might be the biggest event in human history, as super-intelligence could help eradicate poverty, war and disease. However,

before it becomes super-intelligent, goals of AI need to be aligned with ours, aided with ethics and morals.

Like every technology, AI has its pros and cons. AI-powered machines have increased work efficiency and accuracy, reduced cost of training and processes, and much more. To ensure that the risks associated with AI are mitigated, we need ethical codes and policies.

There are three scenarios in which AI might become a risk. These are discussed below:

AI programmed for cyber-attacks and crime. Criminals can automate hacking attempts using AI. To ensure computer systems are safe, policymakers need to work with technologists to spread awareness about possible issues with AI and prevent cyber-attacks. Here are some incidents where AI machines were programmed for devastation:

1. A man posted a video showing him commanding Google Assistant to fire a gun.